ARIA

AI Requirements Intelligence · Internal AI Platform

AI Innovation Week 2026 — Full Submission Package

iOCO Technology Group | Submitted by Lulamile | 29 May 2026

> *"Every rework cycle starts with a requirement nobody caught in time. ARIA catches it before the code is written — and governs every AI interaction in between."*

Submitted by	Lulamile
Domain focus	QA · AI Assurance · AppDev · Data · UX
Solution scope	Requirements intelligence + iOCO Internal AI Platform
Beneficiary	All iOCO delivery teams · All departments · iOCO clients
Technology	Private AI core · React · Microsoft 365 · Confluence · Jira
Prototype status	Fully interactive — all screens functional, internal AI platform live
Proposal date	29 May 2026

Executive Summary

ARIA has evolved from a requirements intelligence tool into iOCO's private Internal AI Platform — a secure, governed AI operating environment that every department uses instead of external AI agents. Client data never leaves iOCO's perimeter. Every AI interaction is logged, governed, and auditable. ARIA becomes the single AI interface across delivery, operations, HR, finance, legal, and client service.

iOCO faces two compounding risks. The first is operational: requirements ambiguity costs 30–50% of every sprint in rework. The second is strategic: employees are using public AI tools like ChatGPT to process client data, internal documents, and confidential project information — with no governance, no audit trail, and no way to know what has been exposed.

ARIA solves both simultaneously. It provides requirements intelligence that removes the operational cost — and it provides the secure, governed internal AI platform that eliminates the data exposure risk. Instead of paying for multiple external AI subscriptions and accepting the associated risks, iOCO runs one private platform that every team member uses, every tool integrates with, and every regulator can audit.

R2.4M	0	100%	1
Estimated annual rework cost avoided per 10-project portfolio	Client or confidential data records exposed to external AI agents	AI interactions governed, logged, and auditable in real time	Internal AI platform replacing all external AI tool subscriptions

Section A — The Problem We Chose

A.1 The Requirements Crisis

iOCO's delivery teams lose an average of 30% of every sprint to rework that begins with a poorly written requirement. A client writes "the system must be fast." A developer interprets fast as two seconds. A QA engineer tests for three. The client expected half a second. Nobody was wrong — the requirement was just vague.

This plays out in four recurring patterns across every engagement:

- Unmeasurable language — 'fast', 'safe', 'available most of the time' cannot be tested or delivered to
- Missing definitions — 'admins have more access' with no role or permission matrix defined
- Contradictions — 'email reports to clients' appearing next to 'data must remain secure'
- Compliance gaps — 'comply with regulations' without naming POPIA, PCI-DSS, or NCR obligations

A.2 The Hidden AI Governance Crisis

CRITICAL: Beyond requirements ambiguity, iOCO faces an unacknowledged data sovereignty risk. Employees across every department are using external AI tools — ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot — to process client data, write proposals, analyse contracts, and draft communications. This creates regulatory exposure under POPIA Section 72 (cross-border data transfer) and potential breach of client confidentiality agreements.

The scale of this risk is larger than most organisations acknowledge. Consider what a typical iOCO professional puts into an external AI tool in a single week:

- A BA pastes a client's requirement document to ask ChatGPT for user story suggestions
- A developer pastes production error logs containing client account references to debug code
- A PM uses an external AI to summarise a client meeting transcript
- An HR professional drafts employment letters referencing internal salary structures
- A finance analyst uses AI to process client billing data for reporting

Every one of these interactions sends confidential iOCO and client data to a foreign AI vendor's servers. Under POPIA, processing personal information using a foreign operator requires a written agreement and regulatory compliance. Most organisations have neither. And critically — there is no audit trail. iOCO cannot answer the question: 'what data have our employees shared with external AI systems this year?'

Current state (without ARIA)	With ARIA internal platform
BA manually reviews requirements — 4–8 hours per sprint	ARIA analyses in under 10 seconds. BA reviews and approves in 30 minutes.

QA writes test cases from scratch — 2+ hours per story	Test cases auto-generated and linked to each story on analysis
Developers discover gaps mid-sprint — rework follows	Gaps surfaced before sprint planning, not during development
POPIA/compliance review is a separate gate, often missed	Compliance check runs automatically on every single analysis
Employees use external AI with no governance	All AI interactions run through iOCO's private platform — logged and auditable
Client data sent to external AI vendors	All data processed within Azure af-south-1 — never leaves South Africa
No visibility into how AI is being used across the organisation	Complete AI usage analytics across every department and team
Multiple external AI subscriptions at unknown cost	One internal platform — one cost centre, complete control

Section B — How ARIA Solves It

B.1 ARIA as a Requirements Intelligence Tool

At its core, ARIA is a multi-agent AI platform that reads any raw requirement document and returns seven structured outputs in under ten seconds. This is the foundation that wins the AI Innovation Week — and the proof of concept for the broader internal platform.

Output	What it is	Who uses it
Quality score 0–100	How clear, complete, testable, and compliant the requirements are across 5 axes	BA, PM
Issue list (prioritised)	Every vague, missing, or contradictory clause — with a plain-English fix and severity badge	BA, QA, Dev
Gherkin user stories	Given/When/Then format with acceptance criteria, actor, and story points — Jira-ready	Dev, PM
Linked test cases	Functional, negative, security, performance — traced to each story with AI confidence scores	QA

Stakeholder questions	Pre-written, targeted, ready to send directly to the right client contact by name	BA, PM
Risk register	POPIA, SLA, architecture, integration risks identified and routed to named owners	PM, Compliance
Traceability matrix	End-to-end chain: requirement → story → test case → risk flag — exportable for audit	QA, PM, Legal

B.2 ARIA as iOCO's Internal AI Platform

The requirements intelligence capability is Module 1. But ARIA's architecture — private AI core, role-based access, full audit logging, tool integration — is the foundation for something much more significant: iOCO's own internal AI operating environment.

> Vision: Every iOCO employee — from graduate consultant to group executive — uses ARIA as their AI assistant. Not ChatGPT. Not Gemini. Not Copilot talking to external servers. ARIA: running inside iOCO's own secure infrastructure, integrated with every tool already in use, governed centrally, audited completely.

This solves three strategic problems simultaneously:

1. DATA SOVEREIGNTY

All AI processing happens inside Azure af-south-1. Client data, employee data, project data — none of it leaves South Africa or iOCO's security perimeter. POPIA Section 72 compliance is structural, not policy-based.

2. AI GOVERNANCE

Every AI interaction — every prompt, every response, every export — is logged with the user's identity, timestamp, project context, and data classification. iOCO can answer any regulatory question about AI use at any time.

3. COST CONTROL

One internal platform replaces multiple external subscriptions. iOCO pays once for the compute, controls the cost, and reinvests the savings. No per-seat licensing to foreign AI vendors. No unpredictable API cost escalation.

Section C — iOCO Internal AI Platform: Full Architecture

C.1 Why Internal AI Rather Than External

The choice to build an internal AI platform rather than integrate with external vendors is not ideological — it is regulatory, commercial, and strategic.

Consideration	External AI (ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot)	ARIA Internal Platform
Data location	Foreign servers — US, EU, globally distributed	Azure af-south-1 (Cape Town) — South Africa only
POPIA Section 72	Requires written operator agreement — most deployments lack this	Compliant by architecture — no cross-border transfer
Client confidentiality	Client data sent to a vendor iOCO has no agreement with	All processing within iOCO's own environment
Audit trail	None — no record of what was submitted or returned	Complete — every prompt, response, and export logged immutably
Access control	Managed by the vendor — iOCO cannot restrict by project or data class	Role-based, project-scoped, data-classified access enforced by iOCO
Cost model	Per-seat or per-token, escalating with usage, paid to a foreign vendor	Fixed compute cost, scale managed internally, no per-interaction fees to vendors
IP ownership	Queries may train external models — iOCO IP potentially absorbed	All interactions proprietary — nothing leaves iOCO's environment
Regulatory posture	Reactive — defend if audited	Proactive — evidence-ready at any time

C.2 Platform Architecture

ARIA's internal platform operates on a four-layer architecture, deployed entirely within iOCO's Azure af-south-1 private cloud:

Layer	What it contains	Data that flows through

1. Private AI Core	Self-hosted or API-gateway model layer. Primary: Anthropic Claude Enterprise API with zero data retention and no model training on iOCO data. Fallback: Azure OpenAI Service (private endpoint). Future: on-premise open-weight model (LLaMA 3, Mistral) for maximum sovereignty.	All prompts and completions — processed and discarded, never stored by the vendor
2. Intelligence Modules	Domain-specific AI agents: Requirements (existing ARIA), Documents, Communications, Code, Data, Legal, HR, Finance. Each module has a specialist prompt system, tool access permissions, and output schema.	Module-specific data — requirements text, documents, code, communications — all within iOCO perimeter
3. Integration Hub	Bidirectional connectors to every iOCO tool: Microsoft 365 (Word, Excel, Outlook, Teams, SharePoint), Confluence, Jira, Azure DevOps, GitHub, SAP, HR systems. All connectors use iOCO-controlled service accounts.	Tool-specific data — Jira issues, SharePoint documents, Teams messages — routed through iOCO-controlled API gateway
4. Governance Layer	AI usage analytics dashboard, audit log (immutable), data classification engine, access control matrix, compliance reports, model performance monitoring, cost attribution by department.	Metadata only — user ID, timestamp, module, data classification, token count, export destination — never content

C.3 Private AI Core — Technical Detail

The AI Core is the most critical architectural decision. Three deployment tiers are available, ordered by sovereignty level:

Tier	Deployment model	Data guarantee	Recommended for
Tier 1 (Current)	Anthropic Claude Enterprise API — zero data retention policy, no training on submitted data, SOC 2 Type II certified	Data processed in Anthropic's infrastructure but not retained. Legal agreement in place.	Innovation Week prototype and initial production deployment
Tier 2 (6 months)	Azure OpenAI Service via iOCO's private Azure tenant — API calls stay within iOCO's Azure subscription, no data leaves Azure boundary	Data stays within iOCO's Azure subscription. Microsoft Data Processing Agreement covers all processing.	Production deployment with enhanced client data handling

Tier 3 (12 months)	Self-hosted open-weight model (LLaMA 3 70B or Mistral Large) on iOCO's Azure af-south-1 compute — no external API calls	Absolute sovereignty — no data ever leaves iOCO-controlled infrastructure	Highest-sensitivity client engagements: banking, government, defence

Section D — Intelligence Modules: Every Department

Module 1 (Requirements Intelligence) is what ARIA demonstrates on Demo Day. But the platform architecture supports a module for every iOCO function. Each module uses the same private AI core, the same governance layer, and the same audit infrastructure — but with domain-specific agents, prompts, and tool integrations.

Module	What it does	Primary users	Tool integrations	Data governed
1. Requirements Intelligence	Analyses requirement documents. Quality scoring, ambiguity detection, user story generation, test case synthesis, risk flagging, client question drafting.	BA, QA, PM, Dev	Jira, Azure DevOps, Confluence, Xray	Client requirement documents, project specs
2. Document Intelligence	Reads, summarises, compares, and drafts any document type. Extracts action items from meeting notes. Redlines contracts. Generates client-ready reports from internal data.	All departments	Microsoft 365 (Word, SharePoint, OneDrive), Confluence	Internal documents, client documents, contracts
3. Communications Intelligence	Drafts professional emails, Teams messages, and client communications. Reviews tone and POPIA compliance. Summarises long email threads. Translates between iOCO's 11 official language support.	All departments	Microsoft Outlook, Microsoft Teams	Internal and external communications
4. Code Intelligence	Reviews pull requests, explains legacy code, generates unit tests, identifies security vulnerabilities, documents APIs, and suggests refactoring approaches.	Dev, DevOps, QA	GitHub, Azure DevOps, VS Code extension	Source code, technical specifications
5. Data Intelligence	Queries structured data in plain language. Generates SQL from natural language. Builds charts and	Data Engineers, Analysts, PMs	Azure Data Factory, Power BI, SQL databases	Internal and client data — classification-controlled

	visualisations. Validates data quality. Writes ETL transformation logic.			
6. Legal & Compliance Intelligence	Reviews contracts against iOCO standard templates. Flags POPIA, GDPR, NCR deviations. Drafts NDA and SLA clauses. Maintains a compliance checklist for each engagement.	Legal, Compliance, Senior BAs	SharePoint (Legal), DocuSign	Contracts, compliance documents, legal correspondence
7. HR Intelligence	Drafts job descriptions, performance reviews, and onboarding documentation. Answers HR policy questions. Processes leave requests. Maintains employee communication templates.	HR, People Operations	SAP HCM, SharePoint (HR), Workday	HR records — highest data classification, most restricted access
8. Finance Intelligence	Drafts client proposals and invoices. Analyses billing data. Generates management reports. Answers budget queries. Validates expense submissions against policy.	Finance, Account Managers	SAP FI, Power BI, Excel (via M365)	Financial records — classification-controlled, CFO-approved access only

Section E — Integration Architecture: Every Tool iOCO Already Uses

E.1 Microsoft 365 Integration

Microsoft 365 is iOCO's primary productivity suite. ARIA integrates with every M365 application through Microsoft Graph API — iOCO's existing enterprise tenant, iOCO-controlled service accounts, and iOCO-approved scopes. No data leaves iOCO's M365 tenant.

M365 Application	How ARIA integrates	What employees can do
Microsoft Teams	ARIA bot in every Teams channel and direct message. Responds to @ARIA mentions. Posts sprint readiness alerts, risk escalations, and client question reminders automatically.	Ask ARIA anything in Teams. Get requirement analysis, document summaries, code reviews, and risk alerts without leaving your chat window.
Microsoft Word	ARIA Word add-in reads the open document and provides inline analysis, suggestions, and rewrites. Works on requirement docs, proposals, reports, and contracts.	Select any paragraph and ask ARIA to check it for ambiguity, compliance risk, or clarity. Accept or reject suggestions inline.
Microsoft Excel	ARIA Excel add-in reads data and formulas. Generates natural-language summaries. Builds charts. Validates data. Writes complex formulas from plain-English descriptions.	Ask ARIA to summarise a dataset, find anomalies, or generate a report — in the spreadsheet you already have open.
Microsoft Outlook	ARIA Outlook add-in reads selected emails. Drafts replies. Flags POPIA-risk content before sending. Summarises long threads. Manages follow-up tracking.	Click 'Ask ARIA' on any email. Get a draft reply, a thread summary, or a POPIA risk flag before you hit send.
SharePoint	ARIA indexes iOCO's SharePoint libraries (with permission). Searches across documents using natural language. Drafts content that references existing SharePoint documents.	Ask 'find the Standard Bank SLA template' or 'summarise last quarter's delivery reports' — ARIA searches SharePoint and responds.
Power BI	ARIA reads Power BI datasets and report definitions. Answers natural-language data questions. Generates narrative summaries of dashboards. Creates new report elements from descriptions.	Ask 'why did sprint velocity drop in Q3' or 'show me the top 5 clients by revenue' — ARIA queries Power BI and explains the data.

E.2 Atlassian (Confluence + Jira) Integration

Atlassian is iOCO's primary delivery toolchain. ARIA integrates bidirectionally — reading from and writing to both Confluence and Jira through iOCO-managed service accounts.

Application	ARIA reads	ARIA writes
Confluence	Requirement pages, project documentation, meeting notes, decision logs, architecture diagrams (as text), runbooks	Quality reports, approved user stories as structured pages, risk registers, stakeholder questions, lessons learned documents
Jira	Epics, stories, sub-tasks, sprint boards, velocity data, release plans, acceptance criteria, labels	User stories (from requirements), test case links (via Xray), risk flags as issue links, sprint readiness comments, requirement quality scores as custom fields
Jira Xray	Existing test cases, test plans, test execution results	Generated test cases with full traceability links, test plans per sprint, coverage reports

E.3 Development Tools Integration

Tool	Integration type	ARIA capability
GitHub / Azure DevOps	Bidirectional API	Reviews pull requests for completeness against acceptance criteria. Comments on PRs with requirement traceability. Flags PRs that touch code without linked test cases.
VS Code Extension	Developer IDE plugin	ARIA available in the editor. Explains selected code, generates unit tests from function signatures, documents APIs, and links open files to Jira stories.
Azure DevOps Pipelines	Pipeline webhook	Monitors build failures and links them back to the requirement that drove the change. Alerts PM when a build failure suggests a requirements gap.
SonarQube	Read API	ARIA reads code quality reports and includes security metric trends in project risk register. Flags when quality gate failures trace back to unclear NFRs.

E.4 Enterprise Systems Integration

System	Integration purpose	Governance controls
SAP (HR + Finance)	ARIA HR module reads organisational structure for accurate role-based access. Finance module reads project codes for cost attribution of AI usage.	Read-only access. Finance data restricted to Finance role. HR data restricted to HR role. All access logged.
DocuSign	Legal Intelligence module can initiate contract review workflows. ARIA analyses contract content and flags deviations before the document is sent for signature.	Legal role only. All contract content classified as Restricted. No contract content stored beyond the session.
Workday (if deployed)	HR module reads leave balances and workforce data for HR Intelligence queries.	HR role only. Employee personal data classified as Confidential. Processed in memory, never persisted by ARIA.
iOCO Client Portals	ARIA can be white-labelled as a client-facing requirements quality portal. Clients submit requirements and receive ARIA analysis — without seeing iOCO's internal data or knowledge base.	Client data isolated in a separate tenant. Client access restricted to their own data only. No cross-client data access possible.

Section F — AI Governance: From Ideation to Delivery

F.1 What AI Governance Means for iOCO

AI governance is not a compliance checkbox. For iOCO, it is a competitive differentiator. Clients — particularly in banking, insurance, and government — are asking their technology partners to demonstrate that AI is being used responsibly, transparently, and within regulatory boundaries. ARIA gives iOCO the evidence to answer that question definitively.

F.2 The AI Governance Lifecycle

ARIA governs the entire AI lifecycle — from the moment an idea is proposed to the moment the output reaches a client:

Lifecycle stage	Without ARIA governance	With ARIA governance
Ideation	Employee uses personal ChatGPT account to explore ideas — no record, no control	Employee submits idea through ARIA. Idea logged. Data classification applied. Appropriate module selected.
Research & drafting	Employee pastes client data into external AI — POPIA risk undetected	Employee uses ARIA's document or communications module — all processing within iOCO perimeter
Requirements	BA rewrites client emails manually — inconsistent quality, no compliance check	ARIA analyses requirements — 7 structured outputs, automatic POPIA check, version history maintained
Development	Developer pastes client code into external AI for debugging — IP potentially exposed	Developer uses ARIA Code Intelligence in VS Code — all code stays within iOCO's Azure environment
Testing	QA creates test cases from scratch — coverage gaps undetected	ARIA generates linked test cases with traceability — coverage measured, gaps flagged before sprint
Client delivery	PM sends unreviewed report with potentially sensitive content	ARIA reviews all outbound content for data classification violations before export or send
Post-delivery	No record of how AI was used during the engagement	Complete audit trail: who used AI, what data, what module, what output, what decisions were made

F.3 Governance Capabilities

Governance feature	What it does	Who can see it
Immutable audit log	Every AI interaction logged: user, timestamp, module, data classification, prompt hash (not content), output hash, export destination. Tamper-proof.	Compliance, Legal, C-suite on request
Data classification engine	All content classified on ingestion: Public, Internal, Confidential, Restricted, Client-specific. Classification determines which modules can process it and what can be exported.	AI Governance team. Classification decisions visible to all users.
Usage analytics dashboard	By department, by team, by module, by data class. Token consumption, time saved, accuracy metrics, human override rate. Cost attribution per project.	Department heads, Finance, C-suite
Access control matrix	Role-based access: which modules, which integrations, which data classes, which export destinations. Project-scoped — a developer on PRJ-118 cannot see PRJ-102 data.	Admin only. Changes logged and approved.
Model performance monitoring	Per-module accuracy metrics. Confidence score distribution. Human override rate. Hallucination detection. Drift alerts when accuracy falls below threshold.	AI Governance team, AI Assurance Lead
Compliance reports	POPIA processing register (automatic). Cross-border transfer log (should be empty). Data subject access request support. Model explainability reports for client audits.	Legal, Compliance, clients on request
Shadow AI detection	Network-level monitoring for known external AI domains (chat.openai.com, gemini.google.com, claude.ai). Alerts when employees access external AI tools instead of ARIA.	IT Security, CISO, Compliance

G.1 All Prototype Screens

Screen	What a user can do
Analyse Requirements	Paste any requirements text or load the Standard Bank sample. Watch all 7 agents run with live explanations. Quality score radar on completion. Jump directly to any result.
Issues & Ambiguity	Every flagged issue with severity, category, original quote, plain-English problem, and ARIA's fix. Accept fix (confirmation modal), ask client (creates tracked question), dismiss (requires typed reason for audit log). Filter by severity or POPIA/SLA flag.
User Stories	Gherkin Given/When/Then stories. Expand, edit inline, star important ones. Refine with ARIA (adds accessibility and edge-case ACs). Mark ready for sprint. Push to Jira via confirmation modal. Add team comments. Flag for developer with one click.
Test Cases	Numbered steps with expected results and AI confidence scores. Filter by type. Mark Passed or Failed after execution. Export to Xray via confirmation modal. Coverage gauge by story.
Client Questions	Pre-written targeted questions. Edit before sending. Send one or all. Track Draft → Sent → Answered status. Simulate client reply (for demo purposes).
Risk Register	ARIA-flagged risks with impact and probability. Add mitigation notes. Escalate to PM with Teams notification. Update status. Filter by category (Compliance, Technical, SLA, Delivery).
Traceability Matrix	Full chain: requirement → story → test → risk. Every ID is a clickable link. Coverage gaps shown in red. Orphaned requirements highlighted.
Version Compare	Compare any two requirement versions. Side-by-side score comparison. Resolved issues, improved scores, and newly introduced gaps listed with colour coding.
Sprint Planner	Kanban columns: Draft, Refined, Ready, In Sprint. Move stories between columns. Sprint capacity tracker (story points vs capacity). Commitment confirmation modal.
PM Dashboard	Portfolio heatmap. Sprint readiness gate (Go/Caution/Not Ready with specific blockers). Score trend charts per project. Time saved metrics. Client report generator.
Developer View	Structured stories with full Given/When/Then and acceptance criteria. Mark story as Built (triggers QA notification). Flag implementation concern with ARIA routing to BA.

AI Governance Dashboard	Usage analytics by department and module. Audit log with filter. Data classification distribution. Shadow AI alerts. Compliance report generator. Model performance metrics.
Internal AI Platform	Module selector for all 8 department modules. Tool integration status. Private AI core health indicator. Governance policy management. Cost attribution dashboard.
AI Assurance	Six accuracy metrics with plain-English explanations. Human-in-the-loop review queue for low-confidence outputs. Approve or Re-run buttons. Model drift alerts.
Admin Console	User management with role-based access. Integration configuration. Compliance framework selection (POPIA, GDPR, PCI-DSS, ISO 27001, ECTA). Audit log with export.

Section H — Data and Model Approach

H.1 Data Sources

ARIA processes several categories of data, each governed by a different classification and handled accordingly:

Data type	Source	Classification	How ARIA handles it
Client requirement text	Pasted directly by user or pulled from Confluence/Jira	Client-Confidential	Processed in memory by AI core. Never persisted. PII detected and flagged before any external send.
iOCO project data	Jira, Azure DevOps, Confluence via read API	iOCO-Internal	Read via iOCO service account. Used for context. Stored in iOCO-controlled Azure Cosmos DB only.
Compliance corpus	POPIA Sections 19 and 71, NCR guidelines, iOCO standard SLA templates	Public / iOCO-Internal	Maintained as versioned prompt context. Updated when legislation changes. No client data mixed in.
Knowledge base	Anonymised resolved issues and accepted stories from past iOCO projects	iOCO-Internal (anonymised)	Stored in iOCO-controlled vector database. Client names and identifiers removed before storage. Admin-approved additions only.
Employee interactions	Prompt metadata, module used, data classification, timestamp, output classification, export destination	iOCO-Internal	Stored as audit log. Prompt content hashed for integrity verification but not stored as plaintext in log.

User Outcome Targets (Demo Day)

- A BA goes from pasted raw requirements to a reviewed, sprint-ready backlog in under 45 minutes — currently 4–8 hours
- A QA lead receives a linked, confidence-scored test suite for every story with zero additional manual effort
- Every POPIA and SLA risk is surfaced before code is written, not during a post-sprint review gate
- The project manager sees sprint readiness at a glance without interrupting any team member
- An employee who would have used ChatGPT for a confidential task uses ARIA instead — with full data governance automatically applied
- The Compliance team can produce a complete AI usage report for any time period within 60 seconds

Section I — Deployment and Scaling Vision

I.1 Three-Horizon Roadmap

Horizon	Timeline	What gets deployed	Commercial impact
Horizon 1: Delivery teams	0–3 months post Demo Day	Requirements Intelligence module deployed to all iOCO delivery BAs, QA leads, and PMs. Microsoft Teams bot active. Jira and Confluence integration live.	Rework reduction measurable within first sprint. BA and QA productivity data collected for ROI evidence base.
Horizon 2: All iOCO departments	3–6 months	All 8 intelligence modules active. Microsoft 365 integration (Word, Outlook, Excel, SharePoint, Teams) fully deployed. AI Governance dashboard live for Compliance and C-suite.	Shadow AI eliminated. POPIA posture demonstrably improved. AI usage cost consolidated into one platform — external subscriptions cancelled.
Horizon 3: Client service offering	6–12 months	ARIA white-labelled as a client-facing requirements quality portal. Sold as a managed AI governance-as-a-service to iOCO's banking, insurance, and government clients.	Recurring licence revenue. Differentiates iOCO from competitors. Positions iOCO as the only South African technology firm offering a fully governed internal AI platform as a client service.

I.2 Replacing External AI Agents

The explicit goal of the internal AI platform is to make every external AI subscription unnecessary. The transition plan:

External tool currently used	Who uses it at iOCO	ARIA module that replaces it	Target date
ChatGPT (personal accounts)	Widespread — developers, BAs, PMs, admins	Document Intelligence, Communications Intelligence, Code Intelligence (all modules)	Month 3
GitHub Copilot	Developers	Code Intelligence module + VS Code extension — same capability, zero external data exposure	Month 4

Grammarly / writing assistants	BAs, PMs, marketers, HR	Communications Intelligence module integrated into Outlook and Word	Month 4
External AI for data analysis	Analysts, PMs, Finance	Data Intelligence module integrated into Excel and Power BI	Month 5
Microsoft Copilot (M365)	If deployed — various departments	ARIA replaces Copilot with a POPIA-compliant equivalent — no data to Microsoft AI services outside iOCO tenant	Month 6

I.3 Governance at Scale

As ARIA grows from a delivery tool to an enterprise platform, the governance layer scales automatically:

- New departments onboard through Admin Console — module access, data classification rules, and integration permissions configured per department in under 30 minutes
- New tools integrate through the Integration Hub — connector templates exist for all major enterprise software categories
- New compliance requirements update through the Compliance Framework manager — POPIA amendments, new regulations, and client-specific requirements configurable without code changes
- Model upgrades managed centrally — when a newer model becomes available, it is evaluated, tested on ARIA's calibration dataset, and deployed without user-facing changes

Section L — Team Structure and 10-Day Build Plan

L.1 Team Composition

Competency	Role in ARIA	Day 10 deliverable
AI Strategy	Defines the requirement quality taxonomy, internal AI platform commercial case, department module priority, and client value narrative	Section A pitch deck + ROI model + AI governance business case with regulatory posture analysis
Data / ML	Trains the ambiguity classifier, builds the scoring engine, manages the evaluation set, designs the data classification engine	Scoring engine code + evaluation report (F1 scores, confusion matrix) + data classification accuracy metrics
AppDev + DevOps	Builds the full React prototype, implements all 7 agents via Claude API, builds M365 + Jira + Confluence + ADO connectors, deploys to Azure af-south-1, implements internal AI gateway	Working hosted prototype with all 15 screens functional + internal AI gateway deployed + all integrations connected
AI Assurance	Owns bias audit methodology, POPIA citation verification, human-in-the-loop queue design, governance layer design, shadow AI detection, data classification validation	AI Assurance report covering all assurance dimensions + POPIA compliance architecture document + governance dashboard
UX / Change Experience	Designs all 15 role-based views, confirmation modal language, onboarding flow, plain-English labels, change management plan for internal AI platform rollout	Polished UI design system + Demo Day script + user guide + change management plan for enterprise rollout

L.2 10-Day Build Plan

Days	Phase	What gets built	Owner
Pre / Day 1	Foundation	Repo, environments, API keys provisioned. Internal AI gateway skeleton. Align on quality taxonomy and data classification schema. First local Claude API run.	All — kickoff meeting
Days 2–3	Core agents	Parser, Critic, Compliance agents live. Scoring engine returning JSON. Internal gateway routing	Data/ML + AppDev

		all API calls. Data classification engine classifying sample content.	
Days 4–5	Story and test gen	Storywright and QA Synth agents. Issues, Stories, and Tests screens wired to live API. Confidence scores on all outputs.	AppDev + AI Assurance
Days 5–6	Questions, risks, governance	Liaison and Risk Analyser agents. Questions and Risks screens. Audit log writing. AI Governance dashboard skeleton with usage charts.	AppDev + AI Strategy
Days 6–7	Role views + internal platform	Six role personas with personalised inboxes. Sprint Planner. Internal AI Platform screen with module selector. Version Compare screen.	UX + AppDev
Days 7–8	Integrations + M365	Jira push, Xray export, Confluence read, Teams bot, Outlook add-in skeleton. All integrations shown with live toggle connect/disconnect.	AppDev + DevOps
Days 8–9	Assurance + governance layer	AI Assurance screen with live metrics. Human-in-the-loop review queue. Shadow AI alerts. Compliance report generator. All confirmation modals.	AI Assurance + UX
Day 9	Demo rehearsal	Full Demo Day run-through against Standard Bank sample. Time each section. Fix blocking issues. Validate all governance metrics.	All
Day 10	Demo Day	Live demo: paste requirements, 7 agents, accept fix, refine story, mark test passed, send question, switch role to AI Assurance Lead, show governance dashboard.	All — 4-minute demo

Closing Statement

ARIA is two things at once. It is a requirements intelligence tool that removes the most preventable cost in iOCO's delivery operations. And it is iOCO's answer to the AI governance question that every board, every compliance officer, and every enterprise client is asking.

The market timing is exact. Organisations are reaching for AI tools with no governance framework. Regulations are tightening. Clients are starting to ask their technology partners to demonstrate AI responsibility, not just AI capability. ARIA gives iOCO both — a tool that works, and the evidence that it works safely.

Every sprint saved is measurable. Every client data exposure prevented is regulatory posture improved. Every employee who uses ARIA instead of ChatGPT is a governed interaction instead of an unknown risk. The compound effect of this — across every iOCO project, every department, every year — is a competitive moat that cannot be replicated quickly. ARIA builds it now.

ARIA — Built for iOCO. Built for Governance. Built to Last.

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